FY 2024 Traditional Public-Private Partnership Program
(Education and Culture Program 2024): Budget Narrative

Partners of the Americas

Partners of the Americas (POA) has prepared a budget as requested by the U.S. Department of State Bureau of Educational and Cultural Affairs (ECA). The budget requests a total of $348,755 from ECA. POA will provide $91,826 for a total program budget of $476,581.

POA has established sound financial management and internal control systems ensuring expenditures are allowable and classified in accordance with internationally accepted accounting principles. POA employs a fully automated accounting system and has annual A-133 audits. The Finance and Administration (F&A) department is staffed with a talented group of professionals with years of experience related to financial administration and reporting. The finance department is made up of a Director of Grants & Contract, a Controller, a Budget Analyst, three financial accountants, and a Chief Financial Officer (CFO) with over 50 years of experience in the fields of finance and accounting, auditing, managing the financial reporting aspects reporting aspects of US Government (USG) grants and contracts, and has significant experience overseeing cooperative agreements. The F&A team works closely with project staff at POA's headquarters (HQ) to monitor spending, ensure costs are allowable, and support implementation of the project in accordance with USG rules and regulations (particularly 2 CFR 200), local laws, as well as POA's internal policies. Our accountants also review spending with project directors monthly and assist with oversight of sub-recipients, end-of-project reporting, and other aspects of project monitoring.

POA uses a robust and cost-effective strategy to determine cost allocation in accordance with USG cost principles, local laws, and internal policies. Our proposed budget for this project was developed by conducting thorough price analyses to identify realistic and fair market values for all projected expenses. Our budget estimates were also calculated based on experience in implementing effective and cost-efficient USG-funded programs. The following budget narrative will elaborate on each line item presented in the budget.

- Individual line items are discussed below following the budget table format requested in the Proposal Submission Instructions.
- Travel costs have been estimated from a survey of airline quotes, USG per diem and lodging rates, and are not specified until final participant selection takes place.

Partners of the Americas
FY2024 Traditional Public-Private Partnership Program (Education and Culture Program)
Assistance Listing Number: 19.415/ Funding Opportunity #SFOP0010173

Budget Summary	Educational and Cultural Affairs	Cost Sharing	Total
Program Costs	**$141,629**	**$115,212**	**$256,841**
Program costs per participant	$5,901	$4,800.50	$10,701.71
Administrative Costs	**$207,126**	**$12,614**	**$219,740**
Administrative costs per participant	$8,630	$525	$9,155
Total Costs	**$348,755**	**$127,826**	**$476,581**
Total costs per participant Number of Participants: 24	$14,531	$5,326.08	$19,857.54

Salaries
Subtotal Salaries: $117,454
ECA Request: $104,840 **Cost Share: $12,614**

I. Salaries*

POA has budgeted for one (1) Senior Director, one (1) Program Director, one (1) Senior Program Officer, one (1) Program Assistant, and general program support at POA's headquarters. Proposed salaries are also consistent with those paid to other personnel engaged in similar work within and outside of POA. Level of effort (LOE) budgeted is based on the scope of the program proposed. The average monthly salaries include a projected 5% increase in 2025 and 2026 to account for inflation and merit increases for all staff, consistent with HQ policies. POA is budgeting salary at a limited LOE as indicated below, as some staff time will be split between the proposed Education and Culture program FY2024 and prior award Education and Culture FY2023 as they work to close the prior award and start implementation of the new award.

1. The **Senior Director**, whose monthly salary is $11,000/month will provide technical guidance as required, supervise the Program Director, and support relations with Department of State, ECA, PAS, and other stakeholders. From August 2024 to December 2025, the Senior Director will contribute 5% LOE to the program. The total for the life of the project is **$10,314**.

2. The **Program Director**, whose monthly salary is $6,400/month will be responsible for financial and programmatic management; supervising staff and managing all aspects of day-to-day activities; maintaining regular communication with ECA and PAS; and ensuring program compliance with regulations. From August 2024 to December 2024, the Program Director will contribute 10% LOE to the existing Education and Culture

FY2023 award. Starting January 2025, and until March 2025, the Program Director will contribute 10% LOE to the proposed program. The total for the life of the project is **$2,500.**

3. The **Senior Program Officer**, whose salary is $5,358/month will be responsible for coordinating the day-to-day activities including reviewing proposed travel grant applications and/or subaward applications; collecting all required documents; preparing and delivering orientation packets; maintaining program budgets; ensuring receipt of the required evaluations and reports; and assisting with semi-annual and final program reports. From August 2024 to December 2024, the Senior Program Officer will contribute 100% LOE to the existing Education and Culture FY2023 award. From January 2025 to March 2026 the Senior Program Officer will dedicate 100% LOE to the project. During April 2026, the SPO will dedicate 50% LOE to the project. The total for the life of the project is **$92,026.**

4. **Program Assistant**, REMOVED**.**

5. As cost share, POA will contribute program support, which are volunteers who will assist in outreach, grantee support, and other programmatic needs as necessary to ensure a successful program. POA has budgeted Program Support for 17 months. POA estimates the hourly rate at $21.90/hour which is based on the U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics' average hourly rate for administrative support personnel. POA estimates 8 hours/day for 1 day/week for 72 weeks. To keep administrative costs to a minimum, **POA will provide this support as volunteer cost share in the amount of $12,614**.

Fringe Benefits **Subtotal Fringe Benefits: $25,401** **ECA Request: $25,401**

II. Fringe Benefits*

Fringe Benefits US-based staff : In accordance with POA's personnel policy a 23.47% fringe rate is applied to POA Headquarters staff salaries for staff based in the United States. This totals to **$23,901.**

Fringe Benefits Colombia based staff: Fringe benefits for Cooperating Country Nationals (CCN) in Colombia, are budgeted at 53.864% of their total salary and are based on POA's current practice in-country. This totals to **$1,500**.

This includes the required benefits in Colombia:

- 8.33% for severance aid (cesantías) on annual income
- 1% interest on severance aid on annual income
- 5.66% for vacation (15 days of vacation/265 working days a year) on annual income
- 8.33% bonus (prima legal de servicios or 13th & 14th month bonus) on annual income
- 8.5% health insurance (aporte a salud) on annual income
- 12% pension (aporte a pensión) on annual income
- 1.044% workers compensation (Riesgos Laborales - Level II) on annual income

- 4% Family Welfare Fund (caja de compensación) on annual income
- 3% for the Instituto Colombia Bienestar Familiar (ICBF) on annual income
- 2% for the Sistema de Aprendizaje National (SENA) on annual income

The total fringe cost is **$25,401.**

Travel **Subtotal Travel: $79,461** **ECA Request: $78,676** **Cost Share: $785**

III.Travel

POA has contracted a travel agency to manage all staff and participant travel in compliance with the Fly America Act.

1. ***Staff Travel***

a. *Domestic Round-Trip Airfare*: Budgeted costs for flights are based on a sample of various cities throughout the U.S. and past experiences conducting program visits for prior programs. The domestic airfare is intended to be used for one (1) staff member to travel for site visits or other sponsored event. This includes supporting the facilitation of group exchanges when in Washington, DC. POA anticipates three (3) trips at **$**378 per round trip ticket, totalling $1,134.

b. *Domestic Lodging & Per Diem:* Budgeted costs for lodging and per diem are based on the USG lodging and per diem rate in Washington, D.C., and other cities in the United States (the rate for the second city in the group exchange program is illustrative, as it is undecided). POA has budgeted $183/night for lodging in Washington, D.C. for 4 nights for the SPO and 4 nights for each of the two group exchange facilitators. It also budgets a reduced USG per diem rate of $71/day for 5 days in Washington, D.C for the SPO twice and each of two group exchange facilitators. In addition, POA budgets $160/night for lodging for three (3) nights and $71/day in per diem for five (5) days in a second city in the United States. The total cost is **$4,751.** The purpose of these trips is to carry out program visits and participate in group exchange project activities in the United States. For three (3) nights in Washington, DC, lodging will be contributed as cost share, totaling **$785**.

c. *International Round Trip Airfare*: Budgeted costs for flights are based on a sample of various cities throughout the region and past experiences conducting monitoring visits for prior programs. POA anticipates one (1) trip at **$1,200** for a round trip Fly America act compliant ticket. The purpose of this trip will be to monitor program progress. POA anticipates two (2) trips for facilitators to support facilitation in Washington, DC at $1,600 each. The total cost is **$3,900**. 4400

d. *International Lodging & Per Diem:* Budgeted costs for lodging and per diem are based on a sample of various cities throughout the region and past experiences

conducting program visits for prior programs. POA has budgeted an average USG per diem rate of $86/day and $150/day for lodging for five (5) days on one (1) trip. The total cost is **$1,266**.

2. *Participant Travel*

a. *Round Trip Airfare:* Budgeted costs for flights are based on a sample of various cities throughout the region and past experiences implementing the Education and Culture award. POA anticipates 24 trips at an average cost of $1,650 per round trip Fly America compliant ticket for a total of **$39,600.**

b. *Domestic Airfare:* POA will cover flights for group exchange participants to travel to Washington, DC as a part of the agenda. POA estimates domestic flights between hometowns or host communities and Washington, DC. At $350 each for 18 participants, totaling **$6,300**.

c. *International/Domestic Per Diem:* Budgeted costs for per diem are based on a sample of various cities throughout the region and past experiences implementing the Education and Culture award. POA estimates a reduced per diem rate of $50/day for 10 days plus two travel days each trip for a total of six (6) trips. The daily per diem rate is intended to cover travel related expenses such as meals and incidental costs. The total cost is **$3,000**.

d. *Visa Fees:* POA estimates visa expenses at a rate of $185 each for an estimated three (3) U.S. participants, for a total of **$555.** There are currently a handful of LAC countries that require visa for U.S. citizens. As POA is unable to predict to which countries U.S. citizens will plan to travel as part of the program, POA anticipates providing reimbursements for three (3) travelers. The Department of State will cover expenses related to the J-1 visas for approximately LAC participants.

e. *Visa-related Travel Fees*: To increase accessibility within the program, especially for prospective travelers from more rural areas in their countries, POA estimates providing a maximum of $275 per participant to assist in covering travel-related costs for visa appointments travel to/from the airport, and other miscellaneous travel expenses. POA anticipates six (6) participants at a maximum reimbursement of $275 each for a total of **$1,650**.

f. *U.S. Hotel for LAC Group Exchange Participants:* POA will encourage group exchange facilitator applicants to include a 3-4 day trip to Washington, DC as a part of the exchange agenda. If included, POA will cover housing, budgeted at an average of $216.50 per night for 18 participants for four (4) nights, totaling **$15,588**.

g. *U.S. Local Travel for LAC Group Exchange:* REMOVED

Contractual **Subtotal Contractual: $105,000**

ECA Request: $55,000 Cost Share: $50,000

IV.Contractual

a. *Subawards*: POA has budgeted for four(4) community-led project subawards at an average of $5,000 each. In addition, POA estimates in-kind cost share from subrecipients at $25,000. In-kind cost share will combine donated volunteer time, supplies, and other materials to support the subaward program. The project subawards will support community-led initiatives aligned with the Program's objectives and ECA's strategic goals. The subawards will be for community-based organizations throughout the U.S. and Latin America. Total ECA costs are estimated at **$20,000.**

   The budgets for the subaward projects are not yet available as the recipients are selected via an open competition once the FY24 is awarded. Subrecipients are selected by POA, an external review committee, ECA, and WHA and all subrecipients will be approved by ECA.

b. *Subawards for Group Exchanges*: POA has budgeted for two (2) subawards to support group exchanges of at least nine (9) participants per subaward, at an average of $10,000 each. In addition, POA estimates in-kind cost share from subrecipients at $10,000/subaward for two (2) subawards. In-kind cost share will combine donated volunteer time, supplies, and other materials to support the group exchange program. The group exchange subawards will support explicitly designed exchange programs aligned with the Program's objectives and ECA's strategic goals. The subawards will be for POA Chapters and organizations throughout the U.S. and Latin America. The total **in-kind cost share** provided is estimated at **$25,000**. Total ECA costs are estimated at **$20,000.**

   The budgets for group exchange projects are not yet available as the recipients are selected via an open competition once the FY24 is awarded. Group exchange subawards will comply with Fly America. Subrecipients are selected by POA, an external review committee, ECA, and WHA and all subrecipients will be approved by ECA.

c. *Technical/Operational Consultant Pool:* POA estimates working with various consultants to support Program activities and work with participants and subawardees on project planning, coordination, communications, etc, at a rate of $300/day for 36 days, for a total of **$10,800**. This is based on previous rates for specialized consultants with similar scopes of work.

d. *Monitoring and Evaluation Consultant:* POA estimates monitoring and evaluation consultancy services, which will include updating an M&E database and providing data analysis. Based on prior experience for similar scope of works, the M&E consultant is at a rate of $300/day for 10 days for a total cost of **$2,950**

Other Direct Costs Subtotal Other Direct Costs: $53,802 ECA Request: $7,953 Cost Share: $64,427

VIII. Other Direct Costs

1. *Honoraria*

a. *Logistics Consultant:* REMOVED

2. *Fees*

a. *Monitoring and Evaluation:* REMOVED

3. *Events*

a. *Exchange Activities:* POA is budgeting $722 to cover costs during group exchange activities in Washington, DC that are not covered by the facilitator. This could include meals with Partners of the Americas and local transportation.

b. *Event and Promotion:* POA is budgeting $500 to attend training events for professional development and improvement of the program in addition to promoting the Program at events to increase visibility.

c. *Event Costs – One-Day, In-Person Peer Learning Event:* REMOVED

d. *Group Meals for LAC Group Exchange:* REMOVED.

e. *Cultural Activities for Group Exchange:* REMOVED.

4. *Communications*

a. *Promotion & Communications:* POA is budgeting $2,672 to increase Program awareness through communications pieces and marketing materials as part of its strategic communications strategy.

b. *Platform Subscriptions:* POA is budgeted for program specific subscriptions such as Microsoft 365, PandaDoc, Replicon, IT reimbursement, and Mentimeter, and other online tools to assist in program management. As the program overlaps partially between awards, POA is budgeting for approximately $50/month and from May 2024 - June 2024 at 25% July 2024 - September 2024 at 50%, and October 2024 - September 2025 at 100% for a total of **$965.**

c. *Online Platform for Subaward Management:* POA is budgeting for an online subaward management platform called Zengine by WizeHive. The platform will host and centralize all relevant programmatic resources including application and funding guidelines, financial templates, proposal writing tips, and grant

management training materials. The platform will allow an applicant to track and save their application, but also if awarded, their reports. Additionally, it allows users to select their preferred language to view the application and grant materials. Based off of current expenses and projected annual increases, POA is budgeting approximately $120/month for 17 months for a total of **$4,520.**

5. *Materials*

a. *Translation and Interpretation Services:* REMOVED – These costs will be supported by another unit at POA.

b. *Supplies:* POA will be mailing PEX cards to United States addresses for travel grant participants so they may receive their per diem during their trip. This will allow for equity and accessibility for those who would otherwise not be able to afford meals and incidentals during the exchange. This line also will cover any printing or materials needed for the group exchange. This totals **$324.**

c. *Supplies:* POA will donate supplies for programming planning and implementation including one (1) computer budgeted at $1,999 and phone budgeted at $699 for a total of **$2,698**.

6. *Volunteer Time*

a. *Volunteer Time:* POA will contribute **$61,729** in volunteer time as cost sharing throughout the life of the project.

U.S. and LAC Volunteer Time				
Item	**# Vol-days**	**Daily Rate**	**Exchanges / projects grants/ Individuals**	**Total Cost Share**
Non-U.S. (LAC) Volunteers				
Participant selection/planning and preparation	2	71.44	18	$2,572
Orientation	2	71.44	18	$2,572
Follow-on engagement	13	71.44	18	$16,717
Communications Support	12	71.44	1	$857
Proposal Reviewer	5	71.44	7	$2,500
Sub total				**$25,218**
U.S. Volunteers				
Participant selection/planning and preparation	2	245.04	6	$2,940
Orientation	2	245.04	6	$2,940
Follow-on engagement	13	245.04	6	$19,113
Communications Support	12	245.04	1	$2,940

Proposal Reviewer	5	245.04	7	$8,576
Sub total				**$36,511**
Total volunteer time match				**$61,729**

POA's accounting system for volunteer time operates under the principle that the person must directly report the actual time volunteered using standard forms (timesheet) and guidelines. POA does not count estimates of volunteer time and our approach is conservative—if there is a reasonable doubt about the validity of submitted hours, POA does not count them. POA has divided time valuation into the three categories stated below. This approach to valuing volunteer time in each of the categories listed below has been reviewed and approved by our auditors:

1. Volunteers who reside in the U.S. POA values its volunteers as cost share as they are professional and technical personnel, consultants, and other skilled labor which are an integral and necessary part of the program. To properly value contributed services from United States volunteers, POA bases the valuation on fair market value. To derive the fair market value, POA bases it on the most recent Occupational Employment Statistics provided by the Bureau of Labor Statistics for all occupations (https://www.bls.gov/oes/current/oes_nat.htm#00-0000). Based on the specialized services provided by individuals with those skills (as they indicate on their signed timesheets), the mean hourly rate will be used to calculate the total value of their contributed services. This valuation is compliant with the 2 CFR 200 which states: *Volunteer services furnished by third-party professional and technical personnel, consultants, and other skilled and unskilled labor may be counted as cost sharing or matching if the service is an integral and necessary part of an approved project or program. Rates for third-party volunteer services must be consistent with those paid for similar work by the non-Federal entity. In those instances, in which the required skills are not found in the non-Federal entity, rates must be consistent with those paid for similar work in the labor market in which the non-Federal entity competes for the kind of services involved. In either case, paid fringe benefits that are reasonable, necessary, allocable, and otherwise allowable may be included in the valuation.*

   For U.S. volunteers POA is budgeting two (2) days for participant selection, planning, and preparation, two (2) days for orientation, and thirteen (13) days for follow-on engagement for each of the 6 volunteers. Based on experience implementing this type of program, POA has calculated eight (8) hours per day. In addition, POA is budgeting one (1) person volunteering twelve (12) days for communications support such as drafting social media posts, writing blogs, and making short videos to highlight the program. Finally, POA is budgeting five (5) days for seven (7) proposal reviewers across Community Project Funding, Group Exchange Facilitation Funding, and exchange participant opportunities. The actual number of hours that each volunteer spends executing the program, however, will be carefully documented following uniform POA guidelines and reported to ECA with the final report. Given the expertise of these individual POA is estimating an average of $30.63/hour, which according to the U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics is the average hourly rate for educational training professionals. **The total cost share contribution is $25,218.**

2. Volunteers who reside in Latin America and the Caribbean. For non-U.S. volunteers POA is budgeting two (2) days for participant selection, planning and preparation, two (2) days for orientation, and thirteen (13) days for follow-on engagement for each of the 18 non-U.S. volunteers. Based on experience implementing this type of program, POA has calculated eight (8) hours per day. In addition, POA is budgeting one (1) person volunteering twelve (12) days for communications support such as drafting social media posts, writing blogs, and making short videos to highlight the program. Finally, POA is budgeting five (5) days for seven (7) proposal reviewers across Community Project Funding, Group Exchange Facilitation Funding, and exchange participant opportunities. The actual number of hours that each volunteer spends executing the program, however, will be carefully documented following uniform POA guidelines and reported to ECA with the final report. To create a similar fair market value estimate for POA volunteers in non-U.S. countries, the GNI per capita for each country (as reported by the World Bank and adjusted for inflation and purchasing power parity) was used to calculate the volunteer time. The resulting hour value for non-U.S. time is approximately $8.93 per hour (or $71.44 per day). **The total cost share contribution is $36,511.**

Indirect Costs **Subtotal Indirect Costs: $76,885** **ECA Request: $76,885**

VIII. Indirect Costs

In accordance with POA's NICRA letter, indirect costs are calculated at 28.28% of total direct costs. Please see copy of the NICRA letter attached. Total NICRA for this program is **$76,885.**